



The Only Trade I'd Always Take

Aggression bubbles, the origin of the move, and the reason the same setup is wrong 80 percent of the time

SIRES × ETHOS ORDER FLOW



NQ • 40 RANGE • BIG TRADES • TWO REGIMES • 19 PAGES

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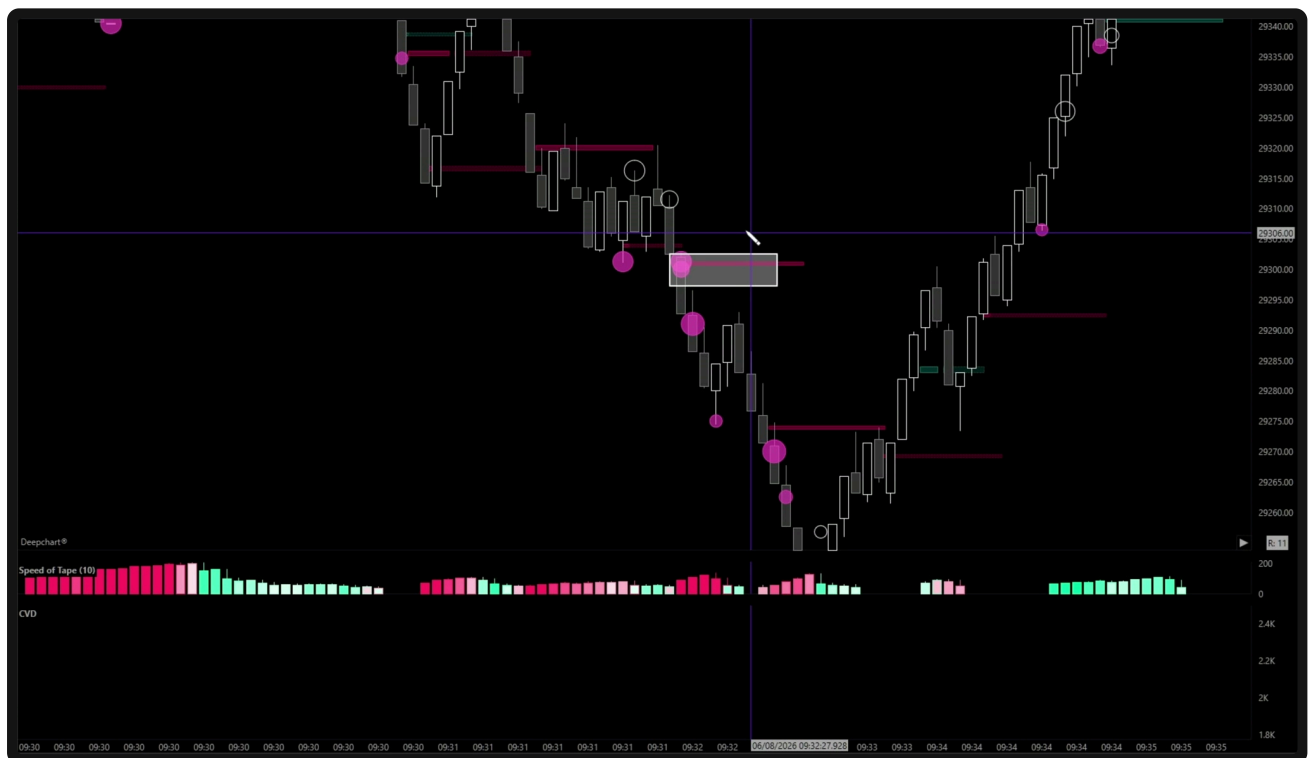
What Big Trades actually is

aggression bubbles, and the settings behind them

Big Trades is the aggression marker on DeepCharts. On the chart it prints as bubbles: pink and purple ones for sell aggression, hollow white ones for buy aggression. The size of the bubble tracks the size of the order behind it.

The settings matter more than the feature does, because they decide what counts as aggression in the first place. On NQ he runs a minimum of 30 contracts and a maximum of 60, on a 40 range chart. That threshold is not a default he inherited. In his words it came "from my data collection, I've seen that it shows aggression." So the number is instrument specific and it is his. If you trade something other than NQ, the honest version of this is that you have to find your own band rather than borrow this one.

NQ, 40 RANGE, BIG TRADES AT 30 TO 60 CONTRACTS



Filled pink bubbles are sell aggression. Hollow white bubbles are buy aggression. The dark red horizontal lines are imbalances, covered on page five. Below the chart, Speed of Tape and CVD.

The misconception that breaks it

effort versus reward, and nothing else

Here is where most people go wrong with any aggression tool, and it happens in the first hour of using one. You see sellers being absorbed at a low and you read it as a buy signal. That is not what it is.

In his own words: "This doesn't tell you when to buy or sell, it just shows you orders, it just shows you information." A bubble is a record that size traded aggressively at that price. It is not a direction.

What makes it usable is the pairing. Aggression is effort. The candle that follows is the reward, or the absence of one. Effort that gets paid is control. Effort that gets nothing is exhaustion. That single distinction is the entire read, and it is why two identical looking clusters of bubbles can mean opposite things.

The trap is that both sides usually show effort at the same time. Buyers absorbed at the top of a range, sellers absorbed at the bottom of it. When that is the picture, you do not know who is in control, because nobody is yet. His instruction there is to wait for the break rather than to pick a side inside the range.

If you can only take one thing from this document, take this one. Aggression measures effort. Price measures whether the effort was worth anything. A tool that shows you the first without you checking the second will lose you money faster than having no tool at all.

The imbalance line

what 350 percent at a single price means

The horizontal lines running off the candles are imbalances. An imbalance prints where there is a divergence between buyers and sellers at one specific price, and on his settings the threshold is 350 percent. A sell imbalance means that price point traded 350 percent more sellers than buyers.

On its own an imbalance is the same kind of information as a bubble. It tells you something happened, not what happens next. What he is looking for is the two lining up: a sell imbalance sitting at the same price as sell aggression. That combination says the sellers there were both large and one sided, and that they were willing to keep hitting into worse prices to get filled.

That last part is the piece worth slowing down on. The best price for a seller is higher. If sellers are accepting lower and lower fills, they are not trying to get a good price, they are trying to get size done. That is what makes the level worth marking, and it is why he waits for price to come back and retest it rather than chasing the print itself.

SELL AGGRESSION AND A SELL IMBALANCE AT THE SAME PRICE



What a squeeze actually is

effort printed repeatedly, with nothing to show for it

A squeeze is a sequence, not a single candle. Buyers come in aggressively. The aggression prints inside the candle body, which is the version that normally means they are being paid. And then price goes lower anyway.

Then it happens again. And again. You end up with several places on the chart where buyers showed real size and got nothing for it. His phrasing is that these buyers "are being exhausted", and that the chart now has "multiple areas where buyers are not willing to price higher."

That accumulation is the setup. Every one of those failed attempts is a group of longs sitting in a losing position, and a group of resting orders above that has not been touched. The squeeze is not the trade. The squeeze is the fuel that makes the trade after it worth taking.

Body or wick. An aggression print inside the body of the candle means that side was willing to trade at worse prices and got carried in their direction. The same print on the wick means the opposite: they pushed, and they were absorbed. It is the cheapest read on the chart and most people never make it consciously.

Origin of the move, and what everyone gets wrong

the failure of the squeeze is not the entry

This is the part of the video he spends the longest on, because it is the part people repeat back to him incorrectly.

The common version goes like this: the origin of the move is where the move starts, so you find the candle where the squeeze failed, and you enter there. It sounds right. The name seems to say exactly that.

His correction is blunt. "People think origin of the move is just you're entering on the failure of the squeeze. No, that's not true." Entering on the failure is entering on the moment the previous attempt died. Nothing has confirmed that a new attempt is starting. You have identified where something ended, and treated it as a beginning.

The failed squeeze does matter. It is what builds the trapped positioning and the untouched liquidity that the real move later runs into. But it is context, not a trigger, and the gap between those two things is most of the difference between this setup working and not working.

THE OFM LEVEL MARKED, WITH THE FAILED SQUEEZE BELOW IT



What you are actually entering

the drive, and why it starts where it does

What you are entering is the drive. His line is that it is "in the name", which is fair, though the name is exactly what misleads people: the origin of the move is the thing that *creates the first movement*, not the low print that preceded it.

Mechanically, the trigger is price taking out the wicks above. In candle terms that says buyers are now willing to pay higher, which is the thing they refused to do through the entire squeeze. The area that was acting as resistance flips to something price can use as support on the way back up.

There is an order flow reason underneath the candle reason, and it is the part worth understanding. The resting liquidity above, where buyers had orders sitting untouched, gets converted once price trades through it. That conversion is what funds the move. Combined with fresh aggressive buyers at the retest, you get a group that is positioned and a group that is being paid at the same time.

He also names the level below it. Price stalls at a refill area, which is a price where sellers previously failed. They did not get their result the first time, so they refill there. When buyers absorb that refill instead of breaking down through it, you have the confirmation.

THE DRIVE OFF THE OFM LEVEL, WITH CVD TURNING BELOW



Why the retest beats the entry that feels early

two entries exist, and only one of them is nameable

There are two entries available on this setup and he is open about it. The break itself is one. The retest of the break is the other. He takes the retest, and the reason is not that it is safer in some vague sense.

At the break you have a sequence you can describe: buyers failed inside the range, sellers failed too, then inside that range the buyers started getting results because the sellers were being absorbed. That is a real change of control. But the break is also the moment where you find out whether it holds, and you are finding out with a position on.

At the retest, the level you are trading has already been defended once. He calls the earlier alternative "prefiring the trade", and the phrase is exact: you are firing on the expectation of confirmation rather than the confirmation.

The honest cost is that the retest does not always come. Some of these move without giving one back, and you miss those. He accepts that trade explicitly, because the entries you can name are the ones you can repeat, and a setup you cannot repeat is not a setup.

The full framework, including how to grade these entries before you take them, is what the lifetime mentorship walks through in live sessions.

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The daily profile, the half nobody screenshots

where the permission to take the trade comes from

Everything up to this point is lower timeframe. On its own it is not enough, and he is direct about that: if you do not understand higher timeframe auction, "you're never going to master it."

The daily volume profile read for this trade runs in order. Current auction was balancing. Price came out of balance. The area being used as support is a minor volume node sitting at the extreme of that balance. Minor volume nodes are worth marking because they tend to give clean rejections and they tend to start trends.

Then the part that decides it. Below that node there is no volume. No volume means no participation, so there is nothing underneath to hold price if it goes there. Volume tries to build lower and fails. That is the asymmetry: above the node there is structure, below it there is nothing.

On the five minute the same story has a bigger frame around it. A yearly composite sits as support, which is 365 days of volume, and there is a bulk of balance with VWAP's median through it, both of which say price is looking for value rather than trending away from it.

DAILY PROFILE: BALANCE, THE EXTREME, AND THE THIN AREA BELOW



The failed auction long

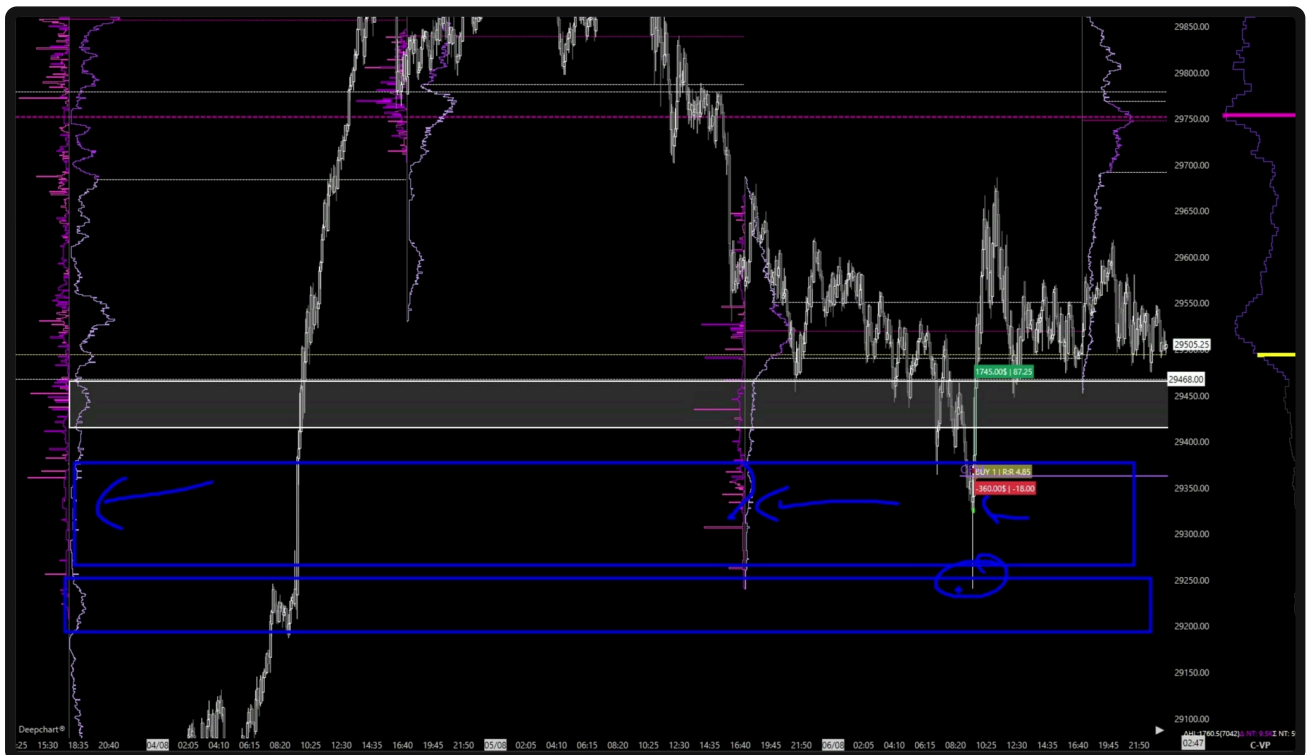
balance, out of balance, rejected at prior value

Put together, the higher timeframe sequence is a failed auction. Price balanced. Price left balance. Price then hit an area that was previously a minor volume node and previously balance, and rejected there instead of accepting into it. His own summary is that this is "a really, really clean failed auction long."

The reason he takes this specific trade, out of everything on the chart, is that both halves agree. The lower timeframe says buyers just took control off the origin of the move. The higher timeframe says price is rejecting away from a level it should reject from, with thin volume underneath and a yearly composite behind it. Neither read is doing the work alone.

That alignment is also what gives you what he calls leniency. If you know the higher timeframe favours buyers, then you know who to give the benefit of the doubt to when the order flow gets messy, and you know which absorption to expect to hold. Without it, every wick is a coin flip.

THE FAILED AUCTION, WITH THE DEMONSTRATED BRACKET AT R:R 4.85



The bracket on this frame is drawn during the review, not a filled trade. As shown it is one contract, 87.25 points of target against 18 points of stop, which is where the 4.85 figure comes from. He moves it while talking, so the exact numbers shift across the video. Treat the shape as the point, not the decimals.

Why prefiring costs you

the roadblocks, and what CVD was actually saying

He goes back to the earlier entry and shows what was in front of it, which is more convincing than the principle on its own.

At the premature long there was sell aggression, a sell imbalance, and repeated sellers stacked above. Price was pushing lower with aggression behind it. CVD was extremely bearish and sitting below its own median, which is the summary version of the same thing: across that whole dealing range down, sellers were in control.

So the entry was not just early in time. It was pointing into everything that was working at that moment. He tells his students to avoid these specifically, and the reason he gives is a win rate one rather than a theory one. The entry can be good and the win rate can still be poor, and on a prop account variance is the thing that removes you, not being wrong about direction.

SELLERS IN CONTROL INTO THE PREMATURE ENTRY, CVD BELOW ITS MEDIAN



Passive moves, and what you want instead

the trap is that it feels exactly like being right

This is the most useful section in the video for anyone already in trades, because it describes a position that is winning and still wrong.

You are long. Price is going up. You check the chart and there is no buy aggression anywhere in the move. No effort on your side at all, just an absence of sellers. He calls this an entirely passive move, and his read is that these are normally short term swings rather than the start of anything.

What makes it a trap is the emotional shape of it. Price runs, you are halfway to target, and confidence is highest at exactly the moment the evidence is weakest. As he puts it, you would be thinking "this is going straight into profit", and the thing you have not checked is whether anyone on your side actually did anything.

The version he wants is a sequence, and the order matters. First the opposition's aggression fails, so they are exhausted, trapped or absorbed. Then your side arrives aggressively. Opposition failing on its own is only half of it, and half is what most people trade.

A MOVE THAT WENT THE RIGHT WAY WITH NO AGGRESSION BEHIND IT



Short gamma, long gamma

the same pattern, two different trades

Everything to this point describes one trade. Then he adds the condition that changes it, and this is the part of the video that is genuinely worth the runtime.

He would only take the origin of the move trade in a gamma short environment. The reasoning is that the setup needs an expansive move to pay, and expansive moves are what a short gamma environment produces. In a long gamma environment the market balances and chops instead, and both extremes get absorbed most of the time.

Which means the same chart pattern, read the same way, is a different trade depending on a condition you check before you look at the chart at all. In balance, the squeeze failing is not a precursor to a drive. It is just the top of the range doing what the top of a range does.

His frequency numbers move around. At one point the A plus plus version happens "once or twice a week, if that", later "maybe even twice a month", elsewhere once every couple of days. The honest read across all of it is a handful of times a month at most, and the direction of the point never changes: it is rare, and you cannot build a month around it.

Against that, his figure for the other environment is stated twice and without hedging. 80 percent of the time the market is in balance. 80 percent of the time you are in a long gamma environment.

Reading the regime before the chart is the part that takes the longest to learn on your own. It is walked through live, daily, inside the lifetime mentorship.

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The trade for the other 80 percent

fade the extreme, on failure of aggression

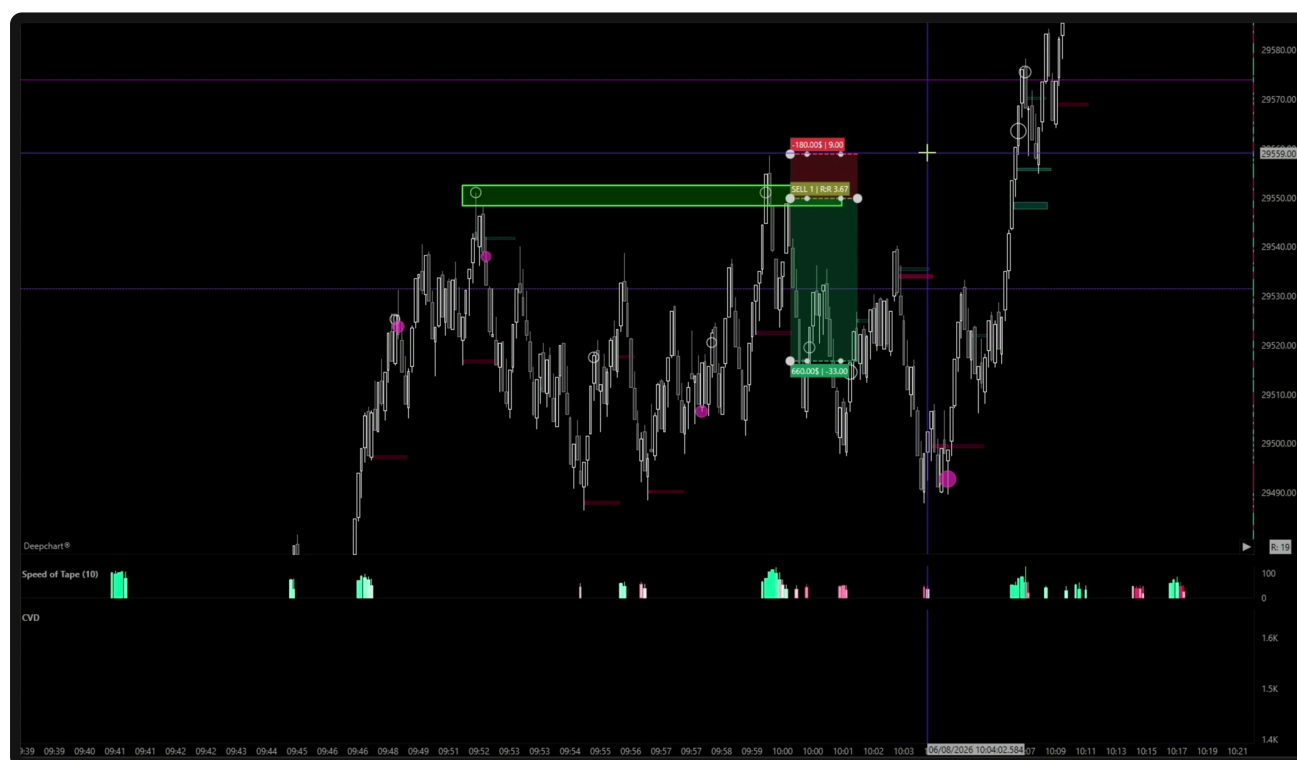
In a long gamma environment the trade inverts, and it gets simpler rather than harder. It is a failure of aggression trade, and the key difference is that you no longer need your own side to be rewarded.

The sequence runs like this. Buyers are absorbed at the top of the range. Price comes back to that area of absorption and those buyers are still not being rewarded. Price goes lower. He waits for the test back into it, enters on the trigger there, and targets back to where sellers previously had control.

The reason it works is the same reason the aggressive version does not. In balance, sell pressure and sell imbalances get absorbed passively, and passive absorption is exactly what carries price in a balanced market. The thing that made a passive move a warning sign in a trending environment is the mechanism you are trading here.

It is also the trade most people talk themselves out of, because they are waiting for a squeeze that a balanced market has no reason to produce.

THE BALANCE DAY FADE, DEMONSTRATED AT R:R 3.67



One contract, 33 points of target against 9 points of stop. Smaller in every dimension than the page eleven bracket, and that is the argument, not a limitation of it. Also a drawn bracket rather than a filled trade.

When aggression finally arrives

the one move in a balanced session that pays like a trend day

Balanced sessions are not uniformly passive. Once in a while aggression does turn up inside one, and when it does the move is disproportionate, because it is arriving into a market that has spent hours absorbing everything.

He points at one of these directly. Everything before it was passive drift inside the range. Then real aggression prints, and the leg that follows is, by his estimate, four or five R before it was even done. His note on it is that "that is a lot" on a prop account, which is the correct frame: it is not a bigger idea, it is the same idea in a moment where the market finally paid for it.

Worth being clear that four to five R is his read off the chart in review, not a logged result. The useful part is not the number. It is that the trade which pays like that is the one you were already taking all session, held longer because aggression showed up to justify it.

AGGRESSION ENTERING A BALANCED SESSION, AND THE LEG THAT FOLLOWED



The prop firm maths

why chasing the big reward to risk works against the payout

The last argument in the video is about account structure rather than order flow, and it is the one that explains why he weights the two trades the way he does.

Traders on prop accounts gravitate to high reward to risk setups because the arithmetic looks efficient. His position is that the skew defeats the purpose. An evaluation is not asking you to produce a large return from a small number of trades. It is asking you to reach a profit target without breaching a drawdown limit, which rewards a higher win rate and steady participation.

He puts the failure case plainly. You can take ten of the rare setups, have all ten lose, and only get back to level if you win the eleventh. That is a survivable model with a long runway and a forgiving account. It is not a survivable model on an evaluation with a trailing drawdown.

Which leads to the framing he closes on: trade a framework, not a strategy. A strategy is a single pattern, and a single pattern only fits one regime, so it leaves you either forcing trades or sitting out most of the month. A framework carries rules for both environments, which is the only way the 80 percent case and the rare case both have an answer.

The A plus plus trade is worth knowing precisely because it is worth waiting for. It is not worth building a month around, and mistaking one for the other is the actual error this video is trying to correct.

The checklist

every rule in this document, printable

BEFORE YOU READ A SINGLE BUBBLE

- ☐ I know whether the market is in balance or out of it, and which gamma environment I am in.
- ☐ My aggression threshold is set for the instrument I am trading, not copied from another one.
- ☐ I am treating aggression as effort, and checking price for whether it was rewarded.

READING THE PRINT

- ☐ Inside the body means rewarded. On the wick means absorbed. I have made that call consciously.
- ☐ If both sides are being absorbed, nobody is in control yet and I am waiting for the break.
- ☐ An imbalance only interests me where it sits at the same price as aggression.

THE ORIGIN OF THE MOVE TRADE, SHORT GAMMA ONLY

- ☐ I can point to repeated effort that got no reward, not just one failed candle.
- ☐ I am entering the drive, not the point where the squeeze failed.
- ☐ Price has taken out the wicks above, and the refill area below held.
- ☐ I am on the retest, and if there is no retest I let the trade go.
- ☐ The higher timeframe agrees: balance left, thin volume behind me, a level that should reject.
- ☐ CVD is not sitting against me on the timeframe I am entering from.

THE BALANCE DAY TRADE, THE OTHER 80 PERCENT

- ☐ An extreme, with the aggression there having failed to get paid.
- ☐ I am entering the test back into that area, targeting where the other side last had control.
- ☐ I am not waiting for a squeeze, because a balanced market has no reason to give me one.

BEFORE I SIZE IT

- ☐ Is my side actually being rewarded, or is this move entirely passive?
- ☐ Does this reward to risk fit the account I am on, or am I chasing a number that will not pay out?

One setup. Two environments to read it in.

The trade he would always take is real, and it is rare. The trade that fills the rest of the month is the one that gets skipped, because it is smaller and it does not look like the screenshots. Most of the damage traders do with an aggression tool comes from taking the first setup in the conditions that only ever produce the second.

Both trades, graded live, on the sessions where they actually appear.

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